

Lesson Information

Topic: Understanding podcasts

Teacher:	Ed Rush	Date:	13 May, 2026
Class:	M3	Duration:	46 minutes
CEFR Level:	B2	Lesson Shape:	E (Receptive Skills (Traditional))
Materials:	OFD 3, Unit 1, pp. 10-11		
Slideshow URL:			

Lesson Aim

By the end of the lesson, learners will have practised and developed the sub-skills of listening for gist and specific information in the context of YouTubers and their influence on teenagers.

Lesson Stages

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
STAGE 1: LEAD-IN			
6 min	To spark interest in the world of YouTube influencers and draw on learners' own experiences	- Display a stat sheet about Mr Beast on the board (subscriber count, estimated earnings, number of views, charity work). In pairs, Ss discuss what they know about him and whether they've watched his content. - Open up the discussion: Who are the most popular YouTubers for people your age? What makes them so popular? Ss share ideas in pairs, then feed back to the class. - Ask: Do you think these YouTubers are a positive influence? Why or why not? Take a few responses from different Ss. Don't confirm or deny – let opinions circulate. - Briefly preview the lesson: today we'll hear a podcast about how YouTubers influence teenagers and why people listen to them.	T-Ss, Ss-Ss
STAGE 2: QUIZ – BEING A POSITIVE INFLUENCE			
5 min	To get learners thinking about what it means to positively influence others	- Direct Ss to the quiz on p. 10 (Task 1: 'Are you a positive influence?'). Ss complete it individually – quick fire. - In pairs, Ss compare answers (Task 2). Were their results similar? Do they agree with what the key says about them? - Take a quick show of hands: mostly As, Bs, or Cs? Read out the key descriptions. Brief class reaction.	S, Ss-Ss, T-Ss
STAGE 3: PRE-TEACH VOCABULARY			
4 min	To equip learners with key vocabulary they'll need to follow the podcast	- Write the following words on the board: persuade, specific, session, talent, community. - Elicit meanings using concept-checking questions. For 'persuade', ask: If I persuade you to do something, do you want to do it at first? Maybe not.	T-Ss

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
		What changes your mind? For 'specific', ask: Is it general or exact? Exact – one particular thing. For 'session', ask: What's a Q&A session? A period of time when people ask and answer questions. • Drill pronunciation where needed (especially 'persuade' /pə'sweɪd/). • Ss copy the words into their notebooks with a short definition or example sentence.	
STAGE 4: LISTENING FOR GIST			
7 min	To get the overall picture of the podcast and identify which ideas come up	• Set the scene: You're going to hear a podcast about YouTubers and how they influence their followers. First, in pairs, discuss how you think YouTubers influence people. • Ss read the six statements in Task 3 (p. 10). Check understanding of any unfamiliar language. • Play audio 1.02 once. Ss listen and tick the ideas that are mentioned. • Ss compare answers in pairs. Play the audio a second time if needed. • Whole-class feedback. Answers: 1 (They give their followers advice), 3 (They share personal information), 4 (They are good listeners).	Ss-Ss, T-Ss
STAGE 5: LISTENING STRATEGY AND LISTENING FOR DETAIL			
12 min	To pick out specific information using a multiple-choice listening strategy	• Draw attention to the listening strategy box (p. 11): underline key words in each question before looking at the options. • Ss read questions 1-5 in Task 4 individually and underline key words. Elicit a few examples (e.g. 'Who', 'teenagers', 'advice' for Q1). • Before playing the audio, Ss read the options a-c for each question and guess the most likely answer. • Play audio 1.02 again. Ss listen and choose the best answer for each question (Task 5). • Ss compare in pairs – do they agree? Which questions are they unsure about? • Whole-class feedback with reasoning: Why c for Q1? What did the presenter actually say? Encourage Ss to point to clues. Answers: 1c, 2a, 3b, 4c, 5b. • Optional: with a stronger group, replay tricky sections and pause to discuss the exact wording that leads to each answer.	S, Ss-Ss, T-Ss
STAGE 6: POST-LISTENING – PLAN A PODCAST			
10 min	To apply ideas from the listening in a creative, personalised speaking task	• Tell Ss: Now it's your turn. In pairs, you're going to plan a short podcast (about 2 minutes) about influencing friends or family. You won't record it today – you'll prepare and present it next lesson. • Elicit a few topic ideas: persuading a friend to try a new hobby, convincing a parent to let you stay out later, talking a sibling into helping with chores, etc. • Give each pair a planning sheet with prompts: (1) What's your topic? (2) Who's your audience? (3) What	Ss-Ss, T-Ss

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
		advice or arguments will you give? (4) Will you use any key phrases from p. 11 (Have you considered...? You might not realize this, but...)? • Pairs brainstorm and outline their podcast. Monitor and help with vocabulary and structure. • In the final minute, each pair shares their topic with another pair for quick peer feedback.	
STAGE 7: WRAP-UP			
2 min	To consolidate the lesson's key takeaways and set up next lesson	• Quick recap: What did we learn about how YouTubers influence people? What listening strategy did we practise? • Remind Ss: next lesson you'll present your 2-minute podcast. Think about your script at home – you'll have a few minutes to rehearse before recording. • Praise effort and engagement. Dismiss.	T-Ss

Transcript

Tape 1.02 — see lesson-1-materials.md (Unit 1, p. 10 ex. 3, p. 11 ex. 5)

Answer Key

Transcription: Student Book, Answers, and Transcript

Unit 1 What connects us?

Life skills

Life skills strategy

How can we influence people positively?

Being a positive influence If you want to persuade people to make positive changes or decisions,

- be positive and offer practical suggestions.
- listen and try to see things from their point of view.
- lead by example, giving examples from your life and other people's lives.

1 Study the life skills strategy. Then do the quiz.

Are you a positive influence?

TRY OUR QUIZ AND FIND OUT!

1 Your friend has an annoying habit: she checks her phone messages all the time. Do you ...? A criticize her in front of other friends B talk about a bad habit you once had and how you dealt with the problem C spend less time with her

2 Your cousins have a new YouTube channel. You think their videos are terrible. Do you ...? A suggest that they give up B offer to help them improve the videos? They trust you, so they will listen C tell them you think they're great, but don't follow them

3 A friend disagrees with you about a homework assignment. He's stubborn and won't listen to you. What do you say? A "Sorry, but I know I'm right." B "I may be wrong. Let's look at the facts." Then justify your opinion. C Nothing. You don't like arguing with your friends.

4 You're doing your homework, but your brother put on loud music. Do you ...? A go into his bedroom and switch off his music yourself B explain why it's a problem and convince him to turn it down C try to ignore it and carry on working

5 A friend posts an embarrassing picture on social media. Do you ...? A tell her that the picture is really stupid B explain how people might react and talk her into taking it down C do nothing, but feel guilty about it

KEY

MOSTLY As You don't try to influence people - you prefer to tell them directly what to do. But people won't listen to you if you're rude. **MOSTLY Bs** You politely say what you think, but you can see things from other people's point of view, too. You are a positive influence! **MOSTLY Cs** You don't like disagreements. Consider influencing people to do the right thing sometimes.

2 Work in pairs and compare your answers for the quiz. Were they similar or different? Do you agree with the key?

3 1.02 You are going to listen to a podcast about YouTubers. In pairs, discuss how YouTubers influence their followers. Then listen. Which ideas are mentioned? 1 They give their followers advice. 2 They offer them free products. 3 They share personal information. 4 They are good listeners. 5 They have a lot of expert knowledge. 6 They influence people in a positive way.

Life skills

Listening strategy

Answering multiple-choice questions

When you have a multiple-choice listening task, underline key words in each question before you look at the options.

4 Study the listening strategy. Read questions 1-5 and underline key words in the questions. 1 Who do teenagers listen to most for advice, according to the presenter? a pop stars b their parents c YouTubers 2 How many followers on YouTube do you need to start earning money? a 500,000 b 17,000 c 1 million 3 How do YouTubers make money? a They sell video games. b They have ads on their channel. c They work for one company. 4 How are YouTubers similar to their followers? a They have special talents. b They are open and honest. c They have similar life experiences. 5 What do YouTubers do when they talk to their followers? a They often film private conversations. b They usually film themselves in a personal space. c They ask their fans a lot of questions.

5 1.02 Listen again and choose the best answers (a-c) to the questions in exercise 4. Did underlining key words help you?

6 Read the role cards and act out dialogues. Use the key phrases below to help you. 1 *Student A* You belong to a cycling club. Your friend has a new bike and you think he/she would really enjoy the club. Think of ways to influence your friend so that he/she joins the club. *Student B* Your friend wants you to join his/her cycling club. You aren't really interested - you have other hobbies and don't have much time for exercising. 2 *Student A* There is a new student in your class who doesn't speak English well and seems lonely. You want to invite the student to spend the day with you and your best friend this weekend, but your friend doesn't like the idea. Think of ways to influence them to include the new student. *Student B* Your best friend has invited a new student to spend the day with you on Saturday. You don't want someone new to join you - you think it will be less fun.

Key phrases Influencing people

Have you considered...? Perhaps you could You might not realize this, but... OK, you've persuaded me. Sorry, I'm not convinced.

7 REFLECT Think about a situation in your life when you tried to influence a friend or family member. Were you successful? What would you do differently now?

Discover more

SEARCH ONLINE and watch some videos by a YouTuber that you like. What strategies do they use to influence and persuade their followers?

— PAGE 11 —

ANSWERS

3 1.02

- In pairs, students discuss how they believe YouTubers influence their followers.
- Then ask them to read the statements and decide which they agree with.
- Play the audio for students to listen and check which of the ideas were mentioned.

ANSWERS 1 They give their followers advice. 3 They share personal information. 4 They are good listeners.

4

- Ask students to read the listening strategy. Ask: Before you listen, what advice does the strategy give for answering multiple-choice questions? (Read the questions carefully and underline the key words.)
- Ask students to read the five questions. Ask: What are the key words? Elicit a few ideas. Ask students to read the answer options and guess which ones are right before they listen again.

ANSWERS possible words to underline: 1 Who, teenagers, listen, most, advice 2 How many, followers, need, earning money 3 How, make money 4 How, similar, followers 5 What, do when, talk, followers

5 1.02

- Play the audio again for students to listen and confirm their answers.
- Check answers. Discuss the clues in each question, e.g., in 1 we know we are going to listen to a podcast about YouTubers and their advice.

ANSWERS 1c 2a 3b 4c 5b

DIFFERENTIATION

- With weaker classes, before listening, briefly review how to say large numbers; make sure you cover thousands, hundreds of thousands, and millions.
- After checking answers, play the audio again for students to listen and note down the numbers mentioned (500,000, 17 million, 40%).

6

- After students read the role cards, read the key phrases with the class and elicit a few examples of how they are used in (a different) context, e.g., Now you have more free time, have you considered joining a gym to get fit? Maybe you could come with me after school. Give students a few minutes to work individually to make a list of ways of influencing a friend and persuading them to agree to something. Monitor and help while they are working, and provide vocabulary as necessary.
- Students act out the dialogues and then reverse roles for the second situation. You could ask some pairs to act out their dialogues for the class to check understanding.

DIFFERENTIATION With weaker classes, allow students more time to prepare some arguments to persuade their partner. Stronger students can go straight into the pair work.

- Alternatively, brainstorm a few arguments with the class and write them on the board. Students could then write the responses, or you could role-play the dialogue with individual students.

7 Reflect

CRITICAL THINKING

- Read the question aloud and point out to students that each person is different, and different methods work well for different people. Ask them to think about which methods helped them in a particular situation. Ask them to think also about which methods don't usually work for them and why. Give students a few minutes to reflect and note down their ideas.
- Put students in pairs or small groups to compare their opinions and offer suggestions. Alternatively, invite some students to tell the class their ideas, and then ask other students: Do the same methods work for you, or do different methods work better? Why?

Extra activity: Critical thinking

- Ask these questions and have a brief class discussion: Have you ever done something you didn't want to because your friend or a family member persuaded you to? What happened? What sort of arguments influence you? Is there someone who can always persuade you to do what they want?

Discover more

- Explain that students should, preferably, choose a YouTuber they are familiar with and that they know influences their followers. You could elicit some suggestions in class to ensure that they are suitable. Students can do the research in class if they have internet access. Alternatively, they can do it for homework. Ask them to make notes.
- After the research or at the beginning of the next lesson, ask students to tell the class about their chosen YouTuber, inviting other students to add their ideas if they chose the same person.

Student Book audio and video scripts

Unit 1, page 5, exercises 3 and 4 Factflix VIDEO

Josh: Hi, I'm Josh ... *Bella:* ... and I'm Bella. Welcome to Factflix. Today we're discussing "Why do we want to fit in?" *Josh:* Nice T-shirt, Bella! *Bella:* Thanks. *Josh:* We have the same taste in T-shirts! *Bella:* And I thought this T-shirt would make me look different. But it's interesting because most people like to fit in... *Josh:* through their clothes, for example. Often because they want to be popular.... *Bella:* ... but also because it's human nature. People feel safer and more confident when they're in groups. And it's easier to be in a group if you fit in. *Josh:* That's true. In terms of music, I like stuff that all my friends are listening to. If everyone likes it, it's cool, right? *Bella:* Er... that sounds like peer pressure to me. Some people say that if everyone likes something, it's extremely uncool. Personally, I have pretty unusual taste in music - I think it's OK to stand out in a crowd. *Josh:* Right... You're in good company then! Did you know that Albert Einstein was a rebel, too? He had a great mind but he hated school! And he was always an outsider. *Bella:* Many extraordinary artists, scientists, and inventors don't follow the crowd. *Josh:* They don't have a lot in common with other people. And they look at the world in a different way. *Bella:* And that might be why they achieve amazing things. *Josh:* So we should all dare to be different! *Bella:* Yeah! It'd be pretty boring if we were all the same! See you next time! *Josh:* Bye!

Unit 1, page 6, exercise 2 1.01

For script, see text on page 7 of the Student Book.

Unit 1, page 10, exercise 3, and page 11 exercise 5 1.02

Youtuber: Hey folks! What's up? It's JJ here. How are you all doing today? It's great you're watching my video because today I got something really cool to show you *Reporter:* In today's world, who influences young people? Who do many of us listen to when we need advice or want to buy something? Is it our parents? Our favorite movie stars or singers? In fact, the people we listen to most are YouTubers! YouTubers often give advice about clothes, music, or friendships. They also play video games, make comedy videos, and film their day-to-day life. They influence the way we look, the hobbies we have, and what we buy. So how do they do it, and why? Well, most of them just love making videos, but there's a money factor too. Different companies often pay YouTubers to advertise their products. If a YouTuber has more than 500,000 followers, they can earn money from ads on their YouTube channel. DanTDM is a popular gamer with over 17 million fans. People watch Dan's site to learn about games like Minecraft, but he has ads on his site too. Dan earns a lot of money every year from these ads. Some YouTubers are also paid to talk teenagers into buying a specific product, such as makeup or a pair of sneakers. Their followers trust them, and if the YouTubers persuade them to buy the product, they earn some money. So how do YouTubers influence and persuade us? Is it because they have a special talent? Is it because they are unusual or different? Not really. Most YouTubers seem to be just like us. They have the same life experiences, the same interests, and the same problems. They are connected to their followers because they view the world in the same way. Teenagers trust the YouTubers they follow. A lot of vlogs are filmed in a personal space, like a bedroom, and YouTubers talk directly into a webcam. It feels like they are having a private conversation with their followers. YouTubers also listen to and reply to comments from their fans, and most of them regularly have Q&A sessions with their community. In fact their fans can ask them almost anything - and they are usually open and honest. According to a study, 40% of teens say that YouTubers understand them more than their friends! YouTubers listen, but they don't judge. But it's not easy to become a YouTuber. It takes time and hard work to make connections with people and build up a large number of followers. So let's meet some of today's most popular YouTubers. First of all....

Unit 1, page 13, exercise 4 Reflect VIDEO

What connects us? Why do we want to fit in? Humans are social animals, and we like to be connected with others. There are advantages to fitting in. When we work with other people, we are more likely to solve problems. When we have friends, we feel supported and liked. However, some of the people who achieved great things in history were outsiders. So, although it feels good to be part of a group, if you stand out in a crowd, you can achieve great things! How can we develop empathy? Empathy is what we feel when we put ourselves in someone else's shoes. Stories are good for developing our ability to empathize, particularly when they are written in the first person. We see the world from the narrator's point of view. Sometimes it's difficult to empathize, but we can always show compassion. If we see someone in trouble, our compassion encourages us to help. How do people adapt and change? In a new environment, people often have to learn a

new language, get used to a new culture, new food, and a different climate, and make new friends. It isn't easy to adapt and change, but a lot of people enjoy their new lives, even though they miss home. Many people around the world have moved to a different country or city. Sometimes they have moved to find work, perhaps they are escaping a natural disaster or a war, or they might simply want to start a new life.